

Speaker 1: [00:00:01] I don't forget. So, [16-20] years, you tell me, right?

Speaker 2: [00:00:04] So I need to close something here, done.

Speaker 1: [00:00:08] But listen, to start with, I'd really like you to tell me about the love story, the relationship you have with [Partner's Name].

Speaker 2: [00:00:15] From the beginning?

Speaker 1: [00:00:17] Yes, that could be interesting.

Speaker 2: [00:00:19] From the beginning. So we met at [location], actually. We were both working [redacted] in a [company]. Initially, [Partner's Name] was also studying. It was kind of love at first sight. Well, it took some time because we were both already involved elsewhere, you know. And then it happened quickly; we got together, [1-5] year later we got married, and that's how it started. Uh. I'd say it's quite a strong bond. We get along very well, we have the same feelings about many things. We like debating various topics. We're not very social, not that we don't like people, but we don't go out much, don't see many people. We're quite similar in that way too. We used to do a lot of sports together, now I can't as much. Unfortunately, that spoils it a bit. Otherwise, what else to say? Our relationship is still as beautiful as it was at the beginning. There was a rough patch [1-5] years ago. But I held on, and now everything is fine again.

Speaker 1: [00:02:00] You said you met during your respective studies, is that correct?

Speaker 2: [00:02:06] No, no, I was working.

Speaker 1: [00:02:08] You were already working?

Speaker 2: [00:02:09] He had resumed his studies late, so we were both about [30-35] years old.

Speaker 1: [00:02:16] You were [30-35] when you met at this [company]r? Yeah. You said you got together and married quickly.

Speaker 2: [00:02:25] Yes, [Partner's Name] wanted to. He was in a hurry. Yeah, yeah. I would have preferred to wait a bit. But as we were living in different cities at first, and he insisted on us being together quickly. So I quit my job and joined him. It was tough for me because I liked that job. It was a hard decision to make at that time.

Speaker 1: [00:02:53] So you got married. How did the relationship develop afterward? Can you tell me more?

Speaker 2: [00:03:01] I'd say it went smoothly. No, no, we get along very well, we respect each other a lot, we understand each other. Over the [16-20] years, it's always been a beautiful

relationship. But there was a tough period in [Year], it ended for [6-10] months and then started again. It was hard for me. I hope it's forgotten now.

Speaker 1: [00:03:35] You mentioned that period twice. Would you like to tell me more about it?

Speaker 2: [00:03:39] Oh well, if you want. I noticed he was different for about [1-5] or [1-5] months. He seemed like a different person to me. Even his appearance seemed different. And he was really not nice to me. One day, during a conversation, he told me he had met someone else but loved us both at the same time. So, I had to either accept it or leave. But I didn't really want to leave either. It lasted [6-10] months; I broke down several times. Then one day, he decided it couldn't continue like that. It was very hard for me. I even wonder if my health problems started from there, but we'll never know for sure. It stays in my mind.

Speaker 1: [00:04:43] It's still in your mind?

Speaker 2: [00:04:44] Yes, it lasted [6-10] months, after all. And since then, I've had serious health issues. But we'll never have proof of that. I try not to dwell on it, though.

Speaker 1: [00:04:58] You mentioned earlier that your relationship with [Partner's Name] is fusionnal.

Speaker 2: [00:05:03] Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:05:05] You said you have a lot in common.

Speaker 2: [00:05:10] We get along well, laugh a lot, have similar interests. When [Partner's Name] was working on his thesis, I helped him a lot with writing and translating, especially on [topic], his research topic. We always discuss work topics. [Partner's Name] is very passionate about it; he doesn't like talking about trivial matters. He's a bit handicapped in that area.

Speaker 1: [00:05:51] It's something you find yourself in as well.

Speaker 2: [00:05:54] Pardon?

Speaker 1: [00:05:55] Something you find yourself in as well.

Speaker 2: [00:05:57] Yes, I accommodate it because I also enjoy having more normal conversations with friends, talking about more basic things.

Speaker 1: [00:06:11] You're talking about your relationship with [Partner's Name]. How would you compare the quality of your relationship with [Partner's Name] to those of your friends?

Speaker 2: [00:06:22] Compared to my friends' relationships?

Speaker 1: [00:06:24] Yes, the relationships your friends have.

Speaker 2: [00:06:28] I couldn't really say because we never truly know what happens elsewhere. They have completely different lifestyles, more normal, I'd say. We are always working, even on weekends. It's not very normal. And since we don't have children, there's no real family life. We set our own schedules. Since I'm [occupation], I work all the time too.

Speaker 1: [00:07:06] Do you think this contributes to the quality of your relationship or detracts from it?

Speaker 2: [00:07:13] No, I think it contributes to the quality because we function the same way and respect each other. If one of us has a lot of work, we support each other.

Speaker 1: [00:07:30] So you think having a more flexible work schedule and lifestyle contributes to the quality of your relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:07:51] Yes, I think so. At the beginning, I had a [occupation] job. I've tried it several times, as we've moved many times, because I prefer job security. I like having fixed hours and a salary. But every time, [Partner's Name] preferred I support him instead of working a traditional job, which stressed me out. So I eventually decided to become [occupation] in translation. It's a bit insecure, but it's a sacrifice I made. I enjoy my work, but it's not always easy to manage.

Speaker 1: [00:08:57] You found yourself stressed in your [occupation] job?

Speaker 2: [00:09:01] Yes. Not the first job when I met [Partner's Name], but later jobs were more stressful.

Speaker 1: [00:09:12] So job security but some stress nonetheless.

Speaker 2: [00:09:15] Yes. I'm someone who gets stressed easily, quite anxious. I'm not very well-suited to the corporate world.

Speaker 1: [00:09:26] Is there anything else about your friends' relationships compared to yours?

Speaker 2: [00:09:35] Yes, my friends go out more, to restaurants, but we never go to restaurants. We prefer knowing what we eat. We're very extreme about that, which desocializes us a bit. We do see my family relatively often, but [Partner's Name]'s family very little, not the same relationship. Our friends go out more, see friends and family more regularly, have children, and do more group activities. I'm more solitary; I walk, run, and do activities alone.

Speaker 1: [00:10:33] When you say group activities, you mean in a group?

Speaker 2: [00:10:35] Yes, group activities.

Speaker 1: [00:10:39] So you both have a more solitary relationship compared to your friends?

Speaker 2: [00:10:46] Yes, completely.

Speaker 1: [00:10:48] And you think this contributes to the quality of your relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:10:53] Yes, absolutely.

Speaker 1: [00:10:56] You're comparing your friends' relationships to yours. Can you compare the quality of your current relationship with [Partner's Name] to your past relationships?

Speaker 2: [00:11:21] You mean previous romantic relationships? There's no comparison. Before [Partner's Name], I was with someone for [11-15] years, completely opposite of [Partner's Name]. A sporty person who loved traveling, partying, and animals. But I was a bit like that too at the time. But he hadn't done higher studies, so there was an intellectual gap. Life was more lively with lots of outings and friends. Completely opposite.

Speaker 1: [00:12:18] So more intellectual stimulation now?

Speaker 2: [00:12:23] Completely, yes. Since meeting [Partner's Name], he got me back into [type of work] work.

Speaker 1: [00:12:32] What you're describing aligns with your life trajectory.

Speaker 2: [00:12:38] Yes, you could say that, completely.

Speaker 1: [00:12:42] At one time, you were more outgoing and party-oriented.

Speaker 2: [00:12:49] Yes, and then I realized I wasn't intellectually satisfied in that relationship or in that job. It was fun but not intellectually fulfilling. So, there was a big shift at [31-35].

Speaker 1: [00:13:20] Tell me what a high-quality relationship means to you.

Speaker 2: [00:13:25] High quality? It's based on respect, support in daily life, sharing, and communication. Always being there for each other, respecting each other's desires even if they're different. That's already quite a lot.

Speaker 1: [00:14:03] How can one know they are in such a relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:14:04] A balanced relationship, with shared responsibilities. Everyday joy and pleasure in being together, without arguments or verbal abuse.

Speaker 1: [00:14:40] How can you know you're in a respectful, balanced relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:14:49] You can feel it, if you feel good with the person. When something's off, you feel it right away, like I did [1-5] years ago.

Speaker 1: [00:15:07] You said you can feel it. Can you elaborate?

Speaker 2: [00:15:10] You feel it in the desire to do things, laugh together, and feel that the relationship is the most important thing. Everything else is secondary if the couple is strong. You feel good in your skin, energized, and eager to do things and share moments.

Speaker 1: [00:15:57] You mentioned personal fulfillment.

Speaker 2: [00:16:10] Yes, in a way.

Speaker 1: [00:16:13] So, you know you're in a good relationship because you're personally fulfilled?

Speaker 2: [00:16:21] Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:16:23] You talked about respect, balance, and fulfillment. What does a low-quality relationship look like?

Speaker 2: [00:16:40] The opposite. An unbalanced relationship, disrespect in communication, not caring about the other person's thoughts or feelings. Not being there for each other, and speaking disrespectfully.

Speaker 1: [00:17:23] You mentioned respect several times. It's important to you.

Speaker 2: [00:17:29] Yes, in a relationship.

Speaker 1: [00:17:34] How does respect manifest itself?

Speaker 2: [00:17:39] Respect means allowing the other person to live as they wish, making compromises so both can find their place. Respecting each other's choices. [Partner's Name] respects my need for sports, I respect his need to work weekends.

Speaker 1: [00:18:16] Respecting each other's integrity.

Speaker 2: [00:18:18] Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:18:21] So, respect also means being able to express who you are.

Speaker 2: [00:18:27] Yes! Over time, we know each other well.

Speaker 1: [00:18:34] Not being restrained in your expression.

Speaker 2: [00:18:37] Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:18:40] You also mentioned communication and the ability to talk respectfully. You mentioned verbal abuse.

Speaker 2: [00:18:52] Yes. What's the role of communication in a relationship?

Speaker 1: [00:18:59] I think it's super important to talk about everything we go through, everything we experience, to share our day, simply.

Speaker 1: [00:19:17] What purpose does that serve?

Speaker 2: [00:19:22] It strengthens the bond, I think. I'm the one who talks more about everyday life because [Partner's Name] isn't very talkative unless it's about work or philosophical debates. It's more complicated sometimes. But we know each other, so even if we don't talk much, it's not a problem.

Speaker 1: [00:20:21] Communication for you is a way to create a bond?

Speaker 2: [00:20:25] Yes, and I think it's important to share everything in a couple.

Speaker 1: [00:20:34] Sharing everything in a couple?

Speaker 2: [00:20:35] Yes, completely. Everything we go through.

Speaker 1: [00:20:41] You've talked about important aspects of a relationship. What is important to you in a relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:20:52] Everything I've mentioned. Respecting the other person as they are. I can't think of anything else right now.

Speaker 1: [00:21:19] You've mentioned important aspects earlier. Based on your experience, what does love mean to you?

Speaker 2: [00:21:35] Love is hard to express. It's abstract. It's feelings we have for someone and wanting to do good for them, to be there for them, to make their life beautiful. When love is gone, it feels destructive. I felt physically and emotionally destroyed when it happened.

Speaker 1: [00:22:22] You said love is wanting to do good.

Speaker 2: [00:22:25] Yes, for the other person.

Speaker 1: [00:22:32] You also talked about the absence of love.

Speaker 2: [00:22:35] Yes, when love is gone, it feels like a physical and emotional destruction.

Speaker 1: [00:22:51] Destructive.

Speaker 2: [00:22:52] Yes, I felt it in my body.

Speaker 1: [00:22:58] How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:23:04] In a romantic relationship, love is essential. Otherwise, there's no point in being together. If the feeling of love isn't there, it doesn't make sense.

Speaker 1: [00:23:20] We know there are different ways to love. How do you know your partner loves you?

Speaker 2: [00:23:31] By the way he is with me, both physically and verbally. By what he says to me, even though he's not very expressive. But I don't miss that. I'm not very expressive either. It's more about physical gestures and daily life, being happy together, making life beautiful for each other.

Speaker 1: [00:24:08] You said by his manner of being with you.

Speaker 2: [00:24:10] Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:24:13] Tell me more. What is this manner that lets you know?

Speaker 2: [00:24:21] It can be through communication, the way he talks, the words he uses, gestures, kindness. When it was the opposite, I felt it right away that something was off. It seems natural because we've been together for a long time. There are gestures of attention all the time. He helps me a lot with many things, especially with my health issues. He takes care of me a lot.

Speaker 1: [00:25:30] So, when love is absent, gestures are absent, communication changes, and you realize something is wrong?

Speaker 2: [00:25:38] Yes, when love is gone, you notice the lack of gestures and changes in communication.

Speaker 1: [00:25:50] And that's how you know your partner loves you too?

Speaker 2: [00:26:02] Yes, that's right.

Speaker 1: [00:26:06] Can you tell me about a recent positive interaction with [Partner's Name]?

Speaker 2: [00:26:17] All interactions are positive. There isn't one specifically.

Speaker 1: [00:26:13] Can you describe one then?

Speaker 2: [00:26:17] A positive interaction? For example, last [Day], I had to go for medical exams and didn't want to bother him because of his work. I insisted on going alone, but he insisted on taking me. It made me happy, even though it bothered me a bit.

Speaker 1: [00:26:59] It bothered you?

Speaker 2: [00:27:00] Yes, because I could manage alone. I don't like wasting his time. But it made me happy.

Speaker 1: [00:27:16] Why was it a positive interaction for you?

Speaker 2: [00:27:21] Because he wasn't obliged to do it. It reminded me of [1-5] years ago when I had the same exam and he didn't offer any help. I had to manage alone. So, it felt very positive this time.

Speaker 1: [00:27:44] The event [1-5] years ago is really a marker for you in your relationship.

Speaker 2: [00:27:51] Yes, it's a marker because it coincided with the start of my health problems. Even though I've forgiven him completely, it stays with me.

Speaker 1: [00:28:14] You mentioned forgiveness. Can you tell me more about it?

Speaker 2: [00:28:18] Yes, without forgiveness, I wouldn't have stayed. Holding onto resentment doesn't make sense in a relationship.

Speaker 1: [00:28:27] In a relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:28:28] Yes. If you're always holding onto it, it doesn't work.

Speaker 1: [00:28:33] Can you tell me more about this forgiveness?

Speaker 2: [00:28:37] Forgiveness came when he tried to come back to me. That made me feel better. It took time, about [1-5] year of doubt and difficulty. But gradually, he became even more attentive and kind to me. And since I really care about him, forgiveness came eventually.

Speaker 1: [00:29:45] Forgiveness came?

Speaker 2: [00:29:47] Yes. But I never bring up that story again. It's better left in the past.

Speaker 1: [00:29:55] So, forgiveness came from his efforts and the passing of time?

Speaker 2: [00:30:19] Yes, and also his decision to change and start again. It changed completely.

Speaker 1: [00:30:23] Can you tell me about a recent negative interaction with [Partner's Name]?

Speaker 2: [00:31:06] We don't have many, but maybe last week in the morning. I was complaining about my pain right after waking up. He was dealing with work issues and told me to stop focusing on my pain and talk about something else. He was a bit harsh, but I understand it's hard for both of us.

Speaker 1: [00:31:53] Why was it a negative interaction for you?

Speaker 2: [00:31:56] The way he responded was harsher than usual. He told me to stop focusing on my pain all the time. It's difficult to manage when you're suffering.

Speaker 1: [00:32:14] As you described earlier, communication should be gentle and compassionate.

Speaker 2: [00:32:29] Yes, it is 80% of the time now. But we avoid topics that can irritate him. We used to debate a lot, but it could end badly because he often wants to be right. Now, I take it more lightly. It's not worth getting upset over small things.

Speaker 1: [00:33:12] Like debates?

Speaker 2: [00:33:13] Yes, for example.

Speaker 1: [00:33:17] What are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:33:25] At one time, it was about living up to his expectations. Now, I accept myself as I am. It's about loving someone as they are, not striving to be perfect. I used to want to be perfect in every way, but that has changed with time.

Speaker 1: [00:34:01] You said living up to his expectations?

Speaker 2: [00:34:03] Yes, I think.

Speaker 1: [00:34:10] Can you elaborate?

Speaker 2: [00:34:14] He used to ask a lot from me in terms of work, like [example]. It was my job, but I didn't want to spend so much time on it. Now, I help him less. I don't enjoy constantly working like he does. It's good to have boundaries. In the past, I wanted to look perfect all the time too. Now, it's more about being natural.

Speaker 1: [00:35:15] Natural.

Speaker 2: [00:35:16] Yes, we are who we are.

Speaker 1: [00:35:20] More accepting and balanced?

Speaker 2: [00:35:22] Yes, and with health issues, you realize what's important.

Speaker 1: [00:35:32] Is it related to a more equal relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:35:40] Completely, yes.

Speaker 1: [00:35:43] With balance?

Speaker 2: [00:35:44] With balance. He still wants to be right about many things, but I don't mind. It's not a problem.

Speaker 1: [00:35:56] You mentioned that sometimes everything isn't perfect in a relationship. Can you tell me about conflicts or disputes with your partner?

Speaker 2: [00:36:08] We don't have many, but the main issue is housework. He's very meticulous, and I'm less so. He often follows me with his cleaning cloths and sponges, which annoys me. It bothers him when things aren't as clean as he likes. That's one point of contention. But we resolve it quickly.

Speaker 1: [00:37:18] What's the frequency of these conflicts?

Speaker 2: [00:37:42] Maybe twice a week, but I wouldn't call them conflicts. We get annoyed for five minutes, sulk for ten, and then it's over. We've evolved to deescalate quickly. Before, we might have had tense relations for days. Now, it's more peaceful.

Speaker 1: [00:38:24] You said it could be related to youth.

Speaker 2: [00:38:32] Yes, youth and knowing each other better over time. I avoid topics that might upset him. He is good at deescalating quickly now. We used to have disputes over trivial matters that lasted for days.

Speaker 1: [00:39:21] How did you resolve conflicts before?

Speaker 2: [00:39:26] With time. You can't stay angry forever. Another issue was [redacted].

Speaker 1: [00:40:40] You said you are more conciliatory.

Speaker 2: [00:40:43] Yes, easier to get along with.

Speaker 1: [00:40:48] In this aspect.

Speaker 2: [00:40:50] Yes, and in general. I'm easygoing and don't confront people. I might tolerate too much but avoid saying things that could lead to a dispute. I'm easy to live with.

Speaker 1: [00:41:27] Is being easy to live with important to you in a relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:41:30] Yes, if I wasn't, our relationship might have ended long ago.

Speaker 1: [00:41:39] Because.

Speaker 2: [00:41:41] Yes, [Partner's Name] is still a very determined person. I would say that things have to go his way. A lot of things have to go his way. So if someone like him is faced with opposition, I don't think it would last long. In my opinion.

Speaker 1: [00:41:59] It's your opinion that interests me.

Speaker 2: [00:42:00] That's what I think.

Speaker 1: [00:42:02] Your feelings. You mentioned the conflicts you could have had at the time, which sometimes lasted several days. And the way you could resolve them, meaning over time. Has this conflict resolution changed recently or is it still the same?

Speaker 2: [00:42:26] Well. As I said, conflicts are really just little things about everyday life, silly things. So, he gets a bit angry. I usually don't say much, but then, well, we both close off a bit, but it lasts ten minutes. And then one of us comes back with humor or something, and it defuses the situation. That really has changed, I would say, in the last [1-5] years now. But I think we don't want these tense relations or silences or those kinds of things anymore. Because there was a [6-10]-month period when sometimes we wouldn't talk for entire days or things like that. And that's the worst. Yeah.

Speaker 1: [00:43:16] Talking about that period again, but.

Speaker 2: [00:43:20] It's ingrained.

Speaker 1: [00:43:23] Of course. But you talk about entire days without communicating, almost being there without being there, almost avoiding each other sometimes. How did you manage that period?

Speaker 2: [00:43:37] I wonder myself. Just through sports. I unleashed by running [1-5] hours a day, all the time, in all weathers. And also felt bad at that level. But that's really how I managed. And at the time, I had a friend I could talk to, so that helped me a lot. Uh, I have a very, very, very loving family, a very close-knit family. However, I couldn't talk to them about it. We're not very... we're a bit reserved in the family; we don't talk about these kinds of things. But well, they were. It's still support. I wasn't alone, and I knew that. It's a bit the most important thing to have a family by your side. And then sports, and well, there you go.

Speaker 1: [00:44:29] Yeah, if I understand correctly, what you're saying is that what kept you going was finding another occupation, something very important to you, in which.

Speaker 2: [00:44:40] Maybe not another. But intensifying it.

Speaker 1: [00:44:43] Intensifying it.

Speaker 2: [00:44:44] Yeah, really.

Speaker 1: [00:44:45] Also having a listening friend, an ear, and a supportive network, which is your family.

Speaker 2: [00:44:53] Yes.

Speaker 1: [00:44:55] Is that why you decided to stay? Because you cared about your partner.

Speaker 2: [00:45:02] You were cut off.

Speaker 1: [00:45:03] The reason you decided to stay is because you cared about your partner. Ah yes.

Speaker 2: [00:45:07] Yes, I couldn't see myself living without him. After everything we shared, it was impossible for me. If he didn't throw me out, I would never leave. No, if he had told me to leave, I would have left.

Speaker 1: [00:45:24] Is that how you endured that period?

Speaker 2: [00:45:26] Yeah. Yes, another source of conflict, but that was the same until [Year]. [Redacted].

Speaker 1: [00:45:52] That's for sure.

Speaker 2: [00:45:53] But well, he allowed me to get a cat, but it was a daily source of conflict.

Speaker 1: [00:46:03] In what way?

Speaker 2: [00:46:05] [redacted]. Yeah, so that was a big source of disputes.

Speaker 1: [00:46:41] But you don't have cats anymore.

Speaker 2: [00:46:43] Now I don't have a cat anymore. It ended badly. He became very possessive of me. Since I am at home all day, one day he... I was typing, and he bit my hand hard. So I ended up in the emergency room with an edema for [1-5] months, and he was becoming aggressive, biting me all the time. So I managed to place him in another family, and now he's doing well. I think he also lacked space at our place; he needed to burn off energy. But it pained me because I'm alone at home all the time. So a cat was nice. Yeah, there you go. But again, I made the sacrifice. If [Partner's Name] couldn't handle it, so be it.

Speaker 1: [00:47:34] Exactly, besides what you described to maintain your relationship, which is communication, the sacrifices you make, are there other ways you maintain this relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:47:51] Well, we have little moments where we always have nice times on weekends. It's always a small moment, really. We have a good laugh, and it's important to keep these weekend moments.

Speaker 1: [00:48:12] If for others.

Speaker 2: [00:48:18] No? After that, it was really something that united us, and we unfortunately can't do it anymore. It was walking together. That was really a passion for both of us. Especially the mountains. Well, maybe that will come back, but right now, it's a bit hard because it was really something that united us. So, it's a bit hard to live without.

Speaker 1: [00:48:40] Yeah. Hum hum. You briefly mentioned this subject, but I would like to know what could make you leave your partner?

Speaker 2: [00:48:51] Like if he threw me out. If he clearly told me he didn't want me anymore, that he met someone else and it's over. Well, I wouldn't force myself in; I wouldn't see the point.

Or if he changed, if his personality changed, if he was no longer the same with me, even if it's not related to another person, etc. I don't know.

Speaker 1: [00:49:23] But otherwise.

Speaker 1: [00:49:29] Uh. You mentioned? I think I lost you.

Speaker 2: [00:49:34] No.

Speaker 1: [00:49:35] It's just. You're moving again. You mentioned several times the sacrifices you could make for the relationship. Are there any sacrifices he makes for the relationship or for you?

Speaker 2: [00:50:05] Besides making me happy by visiting the family, things like that, which he doesn't necessarily want to do, I would say that. But otherwise, no, I don't think there are many sacrifices on his side. Or. No, I don't think so.

Speaker 1: [00:50:28] So, in a more general way, what does he do for the relationship? What does he put into it?

Speaker 2: [00:50:36] What does he put in? His humor, his kindness.

Speaker 2: [00:50:44] If everything that maintains love in the couple. Well. He's always attentive to the other, kind. He takes care of many things. I can't complain about anything. He really has a role. He is very involved in daily life, despite all his work.

Speaker 1: [00:51:15] Hmm. Would you say this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2: [00:51:21] So, yeah.

Speaker 2: [00:51:23] Yeah, yeah. I couldn't be better somehow, at least at the moment.

Speaker 1: [00:51:30] So tell me more about why you think that? Pardon? Tell me more about why you think that? What do you mean by that?

Speaker 2: [00:51:38] Because I... it comes back to why we feel good when we feel loved. It's that we want to live, even if I have a lot of pain, etc. He makes me laugh, and that's important. We have great moments.

Speaker 2: [00:52:00] We. He makes me forget a bit about all that.

Speaker 1: [00:52:08] Hmm. A good relationship can also be, for example, having daily life regulated thanks to the partner or the relationship.

Speaker 2: [00:52:22] Yes.

Speaker 2: [00:52:24] Oh yes, I think we both have such a functioning mode that we know, so naturally, it's... the two functioning modes are intertwined. Somehow, if one started to function differently, that would cause disruptions.

Speaker 1: [00:52:55] It's true that you mentioned an example of a moment when indeed, the relationship or your partner helped you regulate yourself.

Speaker 2: [00:53:18] For example, in work, when I... I get stressed quickly when I have too much. And he knows very well how to tell me how to defuse all that. Because of his job too, I think. He's there for that. He's a support. Yes, he helps me with the thoughts I have about work, etc. Dysfunctional thoughts. We come back to mindfulness; they are just facts, and that's it. Whereas, I can quickly let these kinds of things ruin my life. So, there's no reason for that. So for that, he knows how to get me back on track. He tells me to change my relationship to thoughts, etc. And then, indeed, it works.

Speaker 1: [00:54:34] I would like to know if you think you are the same person as before the relationship? In other words, has the relationship changed you?

Speaker 2: [00:54:42] Oh, yes, completely, yes. Already because, yes, as I said before, before meeting [Partner's Name], it was a completely different relationship and.

Speaker 2: [00:54:59] So. [Partner's Name], yes, he brought me back to a much more intellectual environment. Be it in work or everyday conversations, in the people we met. Changed after. In what way? After yes or no, there are other things that have changed. But it's not necessarily because of [Partner's Name], it's because we moved regions. So I didn't have my friends anymore. After, we found ourselves more alone, and it's harder to make new ones. In sports, I have always done the same amount. That hasn't changed. No, it's mostly at the intellectual level. And then, well, there you go. Before, I was someone who went out a lot, saw a lot of people. With [Partner's Name], since it's not his thing, I became like him, and finally, I realize that's more my true nature. In fact, I don't miss not having people around all the time or going out. We are enough for each other.

Speaker 1: [00:56:27] More your true nature, you said.

Speaker 2: [00:56:29] Yeah, I think so, yeah. You discover yourself with age.

Speaker 1: [00:56:38] So regarding your partner, do you think he has changed compared to before and during the relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:56:51] Well, how he was before, I don't know. In any case, he told me that the person he was with before, on an intellectual level, was not at his level. So, in daily life, he missed something at that level. Uh. After, I think he was much more tolerant with his previous partner, who had lots of cats, for example. And... well, yeah, it's a bit particular because he was with this girl very young, and he lived with his parents at first, so it was more like a family relationship from the start. So it must have been a bit of a special relationship. Then he got into

his studies right away. So after that, I don't know how he was, if he participated a lot in chores, etc. I don't know.

Speaker 1: [00:58:04] Hmm hmm.

Speaker 2: [00:58:08] Anyway, he didn't go out either. All that, I didn't feel it. Yeah, yeah, I even know he was... he didn't miss not going out, staying home all the time, being in his studies, etc. Yeah.

Speaker 1: [00:58:22] We talked a lot about behavior. As a person. As a personality.

Speaker 2: [00:58:30] How he was before. You mean in a relationship?

Speaker 1: [00:58:33] Not necessarily. Before that. Maybe also during the relationship. Do you think he changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2: [00:58:45] Hmm. Yes, I always come back to the same thing, he's much more... he's less into direct conflict too, he's much more at peace.

Speaker 2: [00:59:06] That's really what has changed compared to before. Because he has a pretty... at the time, he used to get angry quickly, even at work. I remember when we worked together, he would get angry with clients, he had no patience. He wasn't someone who seemed easy to deal with. And I experienced it myself sometimes in the relationship, that it could quickly escalate into a conflict starting from nothing. And now, not at all. So I think on his side, he also worked on realizing that it wasn't worth getting into conflicts over nothing and ruining his life.

Speaker 1: [01:00:00] Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2: [01:00:03] Oh yes, yes, yes.

Speaker 1: [01:00:07] So tell me more.

Speaker 2: [01:00:10] Safe. In what way?

Speaker 2: [01:00:13] In every way.

Speaker 1: [01:00:14] What do you mean by safety?

Speaker 2: [01:00:18] That I know he will always be there for me. If I have problems, whether moral issues or health problems, he will always be there for me, that's for sure. At least that's what I think. Financial security. Yes, because he tells me that he is the one who earns the family's money. We always say his money is mine, so I feel secure at that level too.

Speaker 2: [01:00:58] And then.

Speaker 2: [01:01:00] And since that infamous story, I really feel safe. I can't imagine something like that happening again. Well, that's a feeling. Maybe life will say otherwise. But yes, I feel more secure now. More than before.

Speaker 1: [01:01:26] Safety can also be the ability to open up to your partner about your identity, your thoughts, without fear of being judged.

Speaker 2: [01:01:38] Yes, yes, I say everything I think. Yes. And now, we respect each other a lot. We don't try to contradict the other or start debates over what the other is, what they feel, what they live, what they want to share. Hmm. So there's safety. Completely. I feel free to talk to him about everything. And he does too, I think.

Speaker 1: [01:02:12] Are you yourself in the relationship?

Speaker 2: [01:02:16] Oh yes! Yes.

Speaker 1: [01:02:21] Hmm. Safety can also be the ability to get comfort, attention, yes.

Speaker 2: [01:02:32] Yes, always.

Speaker 2: [01:02:36] Somewhere.

Speaker 2: [01:02:37] Really, he is very, very busy with his work. It's true that he has periods when he says he's not stressed, but I think there's still some stress behind it. And so, at those times, he will be less attentive to me because he has other concerns, but I find that normal. I'm the same. But otherwise, no. Otherwise, he is very attentive.

Speaker 2: [01:03:05] And comfort.

Speaker 2: [01:03:06] Also, especially at the moment, I feel it a lot.

Speaker 1: [01:03:12] I would like... Oh sorry, I interrupted you.

Speaker 2: [01:03:15] I said he.

Speaker 2: [01:03:15] Always tries to cheer me up, be positive, etc., when things are not going well.

Speaker 1: [01:03:24] I would like you to give me some examples if you have them. You just gave me an example for the comfort you can have, but for opening up to your partner, is there a moment you think of when you were really open?

Speaker 2: [01:03:48] They find. So he comes like.

Speaker 2: [01:04:05] Because we really say everything.

Speaker 2: [01:04:14] I don't have a specific example. It suits him.

Speaker 2: [01:04:57] So I'm a bit stuck.

Speaker 1: [01:05:00] You say you are yourself in the relationship and also make sacrifices. I would like you to talk a bit more about this duality.

Speaker 2: [01:05:11] Yes, it's contradictory. I was going to say. I realized it at the same time. By the way, I wanted to say it earlier, it's true that I am myself, I am natural, but I will... The only thing is, I won't always say everything in the sense of saying things that might upset. Dad doesn't want to say the truth, but saying things that might upset, I... I dread conflicts. I'm anti-conflict; I don't want there to be conflicts, so... So there you go, I am myself, even if sometimes I would have reproaches to make or want to say things or disagree, I... I keep it to myself. I don't know if it's good or not, but anyway, I prefer that to starting conflicts.

Speaker 2: [01:06:09] But indeed.

Speaker 2: [01:06:10] It's a bit contradictory with being natural. Well, if that's my natural side, somehow.

Speaker 1: [01:06:15] Yes, for you, that's it.

Speaker 2: [01:06:18] But I'm the same with my family. We never say things that might hurt. We are like that.

Speaker 2: [01:06:30] Always peaceful relations, and there you go. Maybe we don't say everything and we should. Yes, I grew up like that and I... and I remain that way.

Speaker 1: [01:06:42] Maybe we don't say everything and we should maybe.

Speaker 2: [01:06:45] Well, it's not that we don't say everything, I will tell him everything. I feel free to say everything. What I don't want is to say things that might hurt or cause conflicts. Hmm. Yeah.

Speaker 1: [01:07:01] Hmm. You said that...

Speaker 2: [01:07:03] You take fewer precautions, let's say. And often, it would escalate into a conflict.

Speaker 1: [01:07:12] And you said maybe it's my natural side.

Speaker 2: [01:07:15] I think now, I always have a warning before saying something.

Speaker 1: [01:07:23] Hmm, there's no.

Speaker 2: [01:07:24] Past experience, or there you go, or it escalated into something, and then there you go. I prefer to be cautious.

Speaker 1: [01:07:33] If I understand correctly, what you're saying is, for you, there's no ambivalence or contradiction in making sacrifices in the relationship and being yourself.

Speaker 2: [01:07:48] I still think that in a relationship, you have to make sacrifices because we are not necessarily in agreement 100% on everything in life.

Speaker 2: [01:08:01] So there you go. And... So sacrifices, yes, we talked about it before, there were examples, but I think it's necessary. Yes, from one side or the other.

Speaker 1: [01:08:19] I would like to now address a constitutive dimension of couple relationships, which is sexuality. We know it can be a more or less important dimension in a couple. What about for you?

Speaker 2: [01:08:34] For me, it's not the most important. For [Partner's Name], it's very important. So I think that maybe here, between quotes, I'm not up to what he would expect. But yes, for me, it's not the main thing. And well, I don't feel the need for a high frequency, etc. It's not... it's not a thing. Maybe more at the beginning of the relationship, after. But besides, in all the relationships I've had, at the beginning, it's more intense, then after no, it's not a thing. It's not my thing. Yeah, it's important, of course, but once in a while, yeah. But I feel it's more important for [Partner's Name], so it's more for him that I... that I engage in the relationship. But I think, deep down, he would like it to be much more often.

Speaker 1: [01:09:49] Several times you mentioned being up to the standard.

Speaker 1: [01:09:53] Is that something.

Speaker 2: [01:09:56] At this level.

Speaker 1: [01:09:57] In a more general way, several times you mentioned not being up to the standard in the relationship.

Speaker 2: [01:10:03] Yes, but in my life in general, I have always set the bar quite high.

Speaker 2: [01:10:16] Yeah, I'm someone quite... quite demanding of myself. And after in the relationship. I think at the beginning, it's the same, we want to show our best side, etc., at all levels. And then, as I said, with the years, we can't always be at our best every day, etc. And either we love each other like that, or... or it doesn't work anymore. It's not the most important either. It's a bit of a seduction game at the start, and then after.

Speaker 2: [01:10:49] They could appreciate daily life. And there you go, you have to be as you are and love each other like that.

Speaker 1: [01:10:57] Yes, you love each other like that.

Speaker 2: [01:10:59] I love him as he is. I hope he feels the same.

Speaker 1: [01:11:04] And you also, you love yourself like that? You love yourself.

Speaker 2: [01:11:08] Oh yes, yes, yes, now yes. I also changed at that level.

Speaker 2: [01:11:16] Because he told me too. He told me, stop always wanting to be at your best! Yeah.

Speaker 2: [01:11:23] But it's true that it's more relaxing not to have to prove anything all the time.

Speaker 1: [01:11:30] I hear what you say. Uh, you talked about sexuality just before. Would you say you are satisfied with your sex life?

Speaker 2: [01:11:46] Yes, but for me, it's not very important. Yes, satisfied, yes. Yeah, I wouldn't want more.

Speaker 1: [01:11:56] It's not something.

Speaker 2: [01:11:57] Well, there you go, if we go back to that infamous period, he was much more demanding at that level, so I complied with that too, but a bit against my will because it was... that was quite horrible to live with, knowing that in his head, he loved two people at the same time. And then physically, you had to be there all the time. And that was very hard, especially since sexuality, frankly, it's not a fundamental thing for me, doing it all the time, no. And it was the case at that time, really contradictory at all levels.

Speaker 1: [01:12:43] Uh, roughly, what would be the frequency of your sexual relations currently?

Speaker 2: [01:12:50] Well, once a week. But after, I have so much pain too, it doesn't help. It's horrible, I can't even move my legs anymore. It's true, it's complicated. Plus the pain is there. It's hard to have pleasure and at the same time be in pain.

Speaker 1: [01:13:15] So there you go.

Speaker 2: [01:13:16] It complicates things even more at that level, that's for sure.

Speaker 1: [01:13:22] I understand what you say. I'll share my screen, share a scale with you. I'll ask you to respond.

Speaker 2: [01:13:32] Okay, you tell me.

Speaker 2: [01:13:34] Wait, just a second. It's starting to rain heavily, and I have windows open.

Speaker 1: [01:13:54] There you go.

Speaker 1: [01:13:55] I'll share it with you right away. You tell me if you see it correctly.

Speaker 2: [01:14:01] Yeah.

Speaker 1: [01:14:02] It's good.

Speaker 1: [01:14:03] In general, my partner really listens to me, so it's on a scale from 1 to 9, one being not at all true, three a little true, five moderately true, seven very true, and nine completely true. Where would you place yourself?

Speaker 2: [01:14:14] Uh, very true.

Speaker 1: [01:14:17] Very true. So why this...

Speaker 2: [01:14:21] Because sometimes I talk to him, and then he does, and then I see that he hasn't listened at all, because he's doing something else. But otherwise. Otherwise, no, he really listens to me all the time. Yeah.

Speaker 1: [01:14:37] Why not... why not eight?

Speaker 2: [01:14:41] I had the choice with...

Speaker 2: [01:14:43] Of course. Yes.

Speaker 2: [01:14:44] Eight then, sorry. Yes, yes, I thought very true was seven, but eight.

Speaker 1: [01:14:49] So why not seven?

Speaker 2: [01:14:52] Because... because he listens to me all the time when it's important. Then, sometimes I tell him unimportant things, and he's doing something more important, so he doesn't really listen to me, and then I realize he hasn't listened. But on important things, he listens to me all the time.

Speaker 1: [01:15:18] My partner is generally attentive to my needs. On the same scale, where do you place yourself?

Speaker 2: [01:15:23] Eight.

Speaker 2: [01:15:26] Also.

Speaker 1: [01:15:29] So why not nine?

Speaker 2: [01:15:53] Because, for example, regarding sports, I have this need to exercise all the time. And then sometimes he still makes remarks that I do too much, that I don't need to every day. Yeah.

Speaker 1: [01:16:11] So why not seven?

Speaker 2: [01:16:14] Because it's rare for him to make remarks. He lets me live.

Speaker 1: [01:16:23] Hmm. How satisfied are you with your relationship? It goes from completely dissatisfied, very dissatisfied, rather dissatisfied, somewhat satisfied, rather satisfied, very satisfied, and completely satisfied.

Speaker 2: [01:16:35] Completely. Yeah.

Speaker 1: [01:16:38] So you answered in linguistic form. If we put that in numerical form, we have a scale from 0 to 10, zero being not at all satisfied, and ten completely satisfied. Where would you place yourself?

Speaker 2: [01:16:57] If we talk about the current moment.

Speaker 1: [01:16:59] Then I lost you for fifteen seconds.

Speaker 2: [01:17:03] I was saying it's really at the moment, right?

Speaker 1: [01:17:07] Yes, yes.

Speaker 2: [01:17:07] Yes, completely satisfied.

Speaker 1: [01:17:10] You can also tell me if it's in a more general way.

Speaker 2: [01:17:14] Well, if I take it over the [16-20] years, it definitely lowers the rating because it hasn't always been as easy. So if we make an average over [16-20] years, I place it much lower. It's hard to say.

Speaker 1: [01:17:38] So why did you put ten on the present moment?

Speaker 2: [01:17:44] Because currently, frankly, I think we're really living a great relationship.

Speaker 2: [01:17:50] At all levels.

Speaker 2: [01:17:50] For me. It satisfies me, and I am with him like this.

Speaker 1: [01:17:59] Very well. Well!

Speaker 1: [01:18:03] Listen, we are reaching the end of the interview. Are there things you would like to add, correct, clarify?

Speaker 2: [01:18:18] I don't think so.

Speaker 2: [01:18:26] We've talked about a lot of things.

Speaker 1: [01:18:27] You can take your time, think about things you might not have said at the moment, or themes you wish to address, or... don't hesitate.

Speaker 2: [01:18:48] Well, the biggest reproach I can make to him in general is really his attitude towards going to family events, [redacted].

Speaker 2: [01:19:24] If it's a thing.

Speaker 2: [01:19:28] This came up again in the conversation when we were having drinks on [Day] evening. We spend [Month] [Day]. In general, the whole family gets together, and he already told me well, we'll go see before. I don't want to be with your brother for no reason. Well, I don't know why because they get along very well too. There's no... but it makes me sad. I don't know how to justify that to my family. It's not easy for me. But well, I respect that too.

Speaker 1: [01:20:03] I understand what you say.

Speaker 2: [01:20:05] Hmm.

Speaker 1: [01:20:05] Are there other things you thought of?

Speaker 2: [01:20:27] We know we've brought a lot to each other. So as much as he put me back on track professionally and intellectually, he thanks me often for teaching him how to write articles, to write his scene. He always thanks me for that. There you go, so we have things to bring to each other. And I also introduced him to classical music. He didn't know it at all because I was a [instrumentalist], and for me, it's a passion, so it became for him too, which is nice. Whereas before, he wasn't into that at all. So that's something nice. I'm happy I could bring him to that. Because he didn't have much opportunity in his family. Indeed, it wasn't a family very much into culture, while mine was. So I kind of brought him into that. And also, my parents are from an intellectual background, and he always enjoys being with them. I think it's because it's focused on high-level topics. The conversations?

Speaker 2: [01:22:02] Very well.

Speaker 2: [01:22:03] There you go.

Speaker 1: [01:22:05] Are there other things? Do you feel like...

Speaker 2: [01:22:10] You have to review a whole life in a few seconds. But.

Speaker 1: [01:22:17] You can take your time.

Speaker 2: [01:22:41] Well, about children. I wouldn't say I made a sacrifice because I never really felt the need, but I know that, well, we got married when we were already [36-40] years old, and I know that just after the wedding, I thought we could have a child, but it was just a passing thought. And for him, it was out of the question because he was still in his studies. And after, he brought it up again when I was already [36-40], and then I said no, we're too old. I didn't want it anymore. So I think that was also a little sacrifice for me. [36-40] was kind of my limit for having a child for it to still be nice, but I don't hold it against him because he had his studies and it wasn't an essential need for me. There you go.

Speaker 2: [01:23:38] And then.

Speaker 2: [01:23:39] And then we built our lives without children, and there you go. No regrets. We don't know what it would have been like. I have more regrets about the cat. There you go, I think that's about it.

Speaker 1: [01:23:57] Very well. Is there anything else? You feel like...

Speaker 2: [01:24:07] Reviewing everything, but...

Speaker 1: [01:24:27] We know we brought a lot to each other. So as much as he put me back on track professionally and intellectually, he thanks me often for teaching him how to write articles, to write his scene. He always thanks me for that. There you go, so we have things to bring to each other. And I also introduced him to classical music. He didn't know it at all because I was a [instrumentalist], and for me, it's a passion, so it became for him too, which is nice. Whereas before, he wasn't into that at all. So that's something nice. I'm happy I could bring him to that. Because he didn't have much opportunity in his family. Indeed, it wasn't a family very much into culture, while mine was. So I kind of brought him into that. And also, my parents are from an intellectual background, and he always enjoys being with them. I think it's because it's focused on high-level topics. The conversations?

Speaker 2: [01:24:32] Very well.

Speaker 2: [01:24:33] There you go.

Speaker 1: [01:24:36] Are there other things? Do you feel like...

Speaker 2: [01:24:39] You have to review a whole life in a few seconds. But.

Speaker 1: [01:24:46] You can take your time.

Speaker 2: [01:24:59] No, no, I think that's it.

Speaker 2: [01:25:05] Yeah.

Speaker 1: [01:25:07] Well, very well. In that case, I'll stop the recording.

Speaker 2: [01:25:09] Okay.